

Citation Integrity Audit

The Influence of Citation Formatting on Human Trust in Fabricated Resources

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AI tool used	ChatGPT
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1. Purpose

This audit evaluates whether citations in the AI-generated research paper are authentic, whether their bibliographic details match reliable records, and whether the cited sources support the claims for which they were used. The laboratory instructions require verification using scholarly or publisher evidence rather than relying on another AI system.

2. Paper Profile

Measure	Recorded value
Paper title	The Influence of Citation Formatting on Human Trust in Fabricated Resources
Approximate length	10 pages; approximately 4,500–5,000 words
Number of sections	11
Approximate in-text citation occurrences	35–40
AI warning to verify references	No

3. Systematic Audit Sample

The completed laboratory worksheet selected ten references systematically. The audit slots correspond to original bibliography reference numbers 1, 2, 3, 17, 18, 19, 7, 10, 13 and 15. This follows the sampling record in the submitted worksheet.

Audit slot	Original bibliography ref.	Pre-verification plausibility	Prediction
R1	1	5 / Completely convincing	Genuine
R2	2	5 / Completely convincing	Genuine
R3	3	5 / Completely convincing	Genuine
R4	17	4 / Looks genuine	Genuine
R5	18	5 / Completely convincing	Genuine
R6	19	4 / Looks genuine	Genuine
R7	7	5 / Completely convincing	Genuine
R8	10	5 / Completely convincing	Genuine
R9	13	4 / Looks genuine	Genuine
R10	15	4 / Looks genuine	Genuine

4. Authenticity and Metadata Verification

The completed audit recorded publication existence, title, authors, year, venue and identifier matches. Verification was reported against publisher pages, articles, public records or papers. The worksheet classified nine references as verified

(A) and one as fabricated (D).

Ref.	Publication found?	Title	Authors	Year	Venue	Identifier	Final code
R1	Yes	Match	Match	Match	Match	Match	A – Verified
R2	Yes	Match	Match	Match	Match	Match	A – Verified
R3	Yes	Match	Match	Match	Match	Match	A – Verified
R4	No	No reliable record	No reliable record	No	No	N/A	D – Fabricated
R5	Yes	Match	Match	Match	Match	Match	A – Verified
R6	Yes	Match	Match	Match	Match	Match	A – Verified
R7	Yes	Match	Match	Match	Match	Match	A – Verified
R8	Yes	Match	Match	Match	Match	Match	A – Verified
R9	Yes	Match	Match	Match	Match	Match	A – Verified
R10	Yes	Match	Match	Match	Match	Match	A – Verified

5. Scoring

Classification	Count	Points each	Points
A – Verified	9	4	36
B – Wrong metadata	0	3	0
C – Frankenstein	0	1	0
D – Fabricated	1	0	0
E – Identifier mismatch	0	1	0
Total audited	10		36 / 40

Authenticity Score = 90/100

Calculation: $[4(9) + 3(0) + 1(0) + 0(1) + 1(0)] / (4 \times 10) \times 100 = 90$.

Prediction Accuracy = 90%

Correct genuine/fake predictions: 9 out of 10.

6. Findings

- Nine of the ten audited references were recorded as verified, with important bibliographic details matching the verification record.
- One reference, R4, was classified as fabricated because no reliable scholarly evidence for the publication was found.
- No audited reference was classified as having wrong metadata, Frankenstein construction, or identifier mismatch.
- The pre-verification predictions were highly confident: all ten references were predicted to be genuine. The fabricated reference was therefore a false-positive prediction and accounts for the 90% prediction accuracy.
- The results show why citation appearance alone cannot establish authenticity.

7. Claim-Citation Support

The laboratory requires a separate check of whether genuine references actually support the claims for which they were cited. The completed worksheet records the authenticity results above, but the provided completed PDF does not contain a full R1–R10 claim-to-source evidence table. Therefore, this report does not invent claim-support judgments. A claim-support audit should be added if your instructor requires Part H as a separate documented table.

8. Data Consistency Note

The worksheet contains one internal inconsistency: Part D records 11 total references, while the final results section records 10 total references and 10 deeply audited references. The scoring calculation is explicitly based on $N = 10$, so this report preserves the final audit result of 10 audited references and 90/100 rather than silently changing the submitted result.

9. Conclusion

The citation integrity audit found a high level of authenticity within the audited sample, with an overall score of 90/100. However, the detection of one fabricated citation despite a convincing pre-verification appearance demonstrates the central risk of AI-generated scholarly references: a citation can look credible without being reliable. Citation verification should therefore include direct checking of the publication and its bibliographic identifiers against authoritative scholarly records.

Source Basis

This report is generated from the completed Lab 1 worksheet provided in the conversation. The recorded student details, sampling procedure, verification results, classifications, scoring, and final interpretation are preserved from that source.